

ZACHARY BUTLER

Instructional Media
Producer

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🌐 ctrlz.cc

SOCIAL

in zachary-butler

PROFILE

Instructional Media Producer with 10+ years of experience translating technically complex subjects — from computer architecture and data science to standardized quantitative curricula — into clear, engaging video in direct collaboration with faculty and subject-matter experts. Builds scalable production systems combining hands-on craft with AI-assisted workflows for scripting, visual development, and post-production.

SKILLS

Technical Proficiency

- ▶ Adobe Premiere Pro
- ▶ Adobe After Effects
- ▶ Adobe Firefly
- ▶ Adobe Photoshop
- ▶ Adobe Audition
- ▶ DaVinci Resolve
- ▶ ElevenLabs
- ▶ Frame.io

EXPERIENCE

FOUNDER / PRODUCER

2025 - Present | Lesson Zero Studio | Laramie, WY

Founded an edtech-focused video production studio; own end-to-end process from concept and scripting through directing, shooting, editing, color grading, and delivery — integrating AI tools for visual development, animation scripting, and audio workflow

Produced content for clients including Zembla (an online educational quiz bowl platform)

INSTRUCTIONAL MEDIA PRODUCER

2021 - 2025 | Cornell University

Produced 2021 updates for the edX course “The Computing Technology Inside Your Smartphone” in direct collaboration with a Cornell computer architecture faculty member; directed on-camera performance and developed instructional graphics to translate complex technical concepts for a broad, non-specialist audience

Produced *Nobody's Fault: An Interactive Experience in Data Science Practice*, a branching-narrative interactive video for a data science ethics course; served as on-the-ground producer working directly with the course instructor on design and execution while coordinating with a remote director

Drove a 5x increase in views and 2x increase in subscribers for the department YouTube channel

EDITOR

2017 - 2020 | FBE, INC

Edited 2-3 videos per week averaging 1-2M views for the REACT and REPLAY YouTube channels — high-volume, deadline-driven production requiring rapid iteration and consistent quality at scale

Finalized episodes with sound design, color correction, and motion graphics

Developed and implemented new post-production workflows that improved editor and assistant editor efficiency department-wide

TEST PREP INSTRUCTOR

2011 - 2014 | Kaplan

Taught in-person GRE, LSAT, and GMAT prep courses to classes of 10-25 students; GRE quantitative curriculum covers algebra, geometry, statistics, and data analysis, requiring students to achieve genuine fluency with mathematical reasoning concepts

Developed instructional approaches to make quantitative reasoning accessible across a wide range of student math backgrounds

- ▶ Panopto
- ▶ Google Suite

Core Competencies

- ▶ Educational Video Production
- ▶ End-to-End Production Ownership
- ▶ AI-Assisted Production Workflows
- ▶ Technical Subject Translation
- ▶ Instructional Graphics Development
- ▶ Format Prototyping
- ▶ Faculty & SME Collaboration

EDUCATION

MASTER OF ARTS

2008 - 2010 | University of Wisconsin-Milwaukee
Film, Television, and New Media Studies

BACHELOR OF ARTS

2004 - 2008 | University of Montevallo
English Literature

○ ADJUNCT INSTRUCTOR

2010 - 2013 | University of Montevallo
Taught first-year composition and literature survey courses to 24-30 students per class; designed all syllabi, assignments, and assessments independently

○ EDITOR

2015 - 2017 | DEFY Media
Edited branded content for major clients including Google, Sony, Kellogg's, and Blizzard Entertainment across DEFY MEDIA brands including Smosh and Clevver TV

○ PRODUCER/EDITOR — FREELANCE

2013 - 2024 | Various Clients
Caltech — Faculty video bios, fundraising content, and academic social media for a leading technical research institution
Wizards of the Coast — Edited videos for Magic: The Gathering channel translating complex strategic and rules content for a dedicated enthusiast audience
Burning Sofa — Podcast and social media video production